



# PunkBackup — Troubleshooting Manual

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This manual shows the app in **English** — go to "■ Settings" → "English" if it isn't already switched (instant, no restart).

## "Start backup" does nothing / doesn't change state

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- Fully close the app (not just minimize it) and reopen it from the Desktop icon.
- If it happens again, you should now get an error window with the exact detail (instead of failing silently) — send us that text.
- Make sure there isn't another copy of the app already open (check the taskbar).

## The iPhone can't reach the server

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1. Confirm the iPhone and the PC are on the **same WiFi network** (check the exact name in WiFi settings on both — some routers have separate 2.4GHz/5GHz networks with similar-looking names).
2. From Safari on the iPhone, try opening the address the app shows you (e.g. `http://PC-NAME.local:8787/health`). If it doesn't load, try the "Fallback IP" the app also shows.
3. Confirm the server is on in the PC app ("Status: Listening on port...").
4. Check the Firewall rule exists: PowerShell (as administrator) → `Get-NetFirewallRule -DisplayName "PunkBackup"`. If it's missing (e.g. you skipped that checkbox during install), add it with `New-NetFirewallRule -DisplayName "PunkBackup" -Direction Inbound -Protocol TCP -LocalPort 8787 -Profile Private -Action Allow`.

## 401 error "Missing or invalid X-Backup-Token header"

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- The token in the Shortcut doesn't match your profile's token on the PC.
- In the Shortcut, check **every** action with an X-Backup-Token header — the value must be the Token variable **chip** (colored background), never the literal word "Token" typed as plain text.
- Copy the token again from the app ("Copy token" button on the profile) and paste it into the corresponding **Text** action in the Shortcut.

## 403 error "This profile is paused"

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- The profile is **Paused**. Open the app → "Main" or "■ Settings" → switch it to **Active**.

## 409 error "no destination folder configured"

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- That profile has no destination folder. Go to "■ Settings" → "Choose folder..." for that profile.

## The Shortcut runs but doesn't upload any new photo

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- Check "**Find Photos**" has no stray filter beyond the `Date Taken is before Limit` one described in the iPhone Setup Manual — a different filter sneaking in makes it return 0 results silently, with no visible error.
- Check **Limit** is turned **on** and set to **50** on `Find Photos` — this is mandatory (not optional): without it, `Find Photos` fails outright on a large library, even doing nothing but counting results.
- Confirm under **iPhone Settings** → **Privacy & Security** → **Photos** that the Shortcuts app has access ("All Photos" / "Always Allow") — with limited access, a photo you just took or saved may simply not be visible to the Shortcut yet, with no error shown.

## My library is huge (thousands of photos) — will the full backup ever finish?

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The Shortcut sweeps your library backward in bounded blocks of 50, newest photos first, advancing automatically block after block within one run — see the "Set up the backward block-sweep" step of the iPhone Setup Manual. This is what makes a large library actually finish, instead of either timing out (no `Limit`) or getting stuck re-checking the same fixed set forever (a plain `Limit` with no way to advance).

- The number of blocks per run is controlled by the `Repeticiones` variable (a `Text` action near the top, defaults to 50). Confirmed working with `Repeticiones` up to 50 (≈2500 photos checked in one run). For your very first full backfill of a large library, it's fine to run the Shortcut several times in a row rather than pushing `Repeticiones` very high on the first try — watch the PC app's activity log (use "■ Expand" for a bigger view) to see it's keeping up before raising the number.
- **Videos can currently arrive empty (0 bytes) — sometimes consistently, not just occasionally.** The server always detects and rejects this automatically, so it's never recorded as a real backup and the same video is simply retried on a later run instead — but the underlying cause (why the iPhone sometimes sends an empty body for a video specifically) isn't fully understood yet: it's not iCloud storage optimization, not a fixed file-size limit, and it isn't reliably fixed by keeping the Shortcuts app in the foreground either — this is an open issue, not a solved one. Photos are unaffected (confirmed reliable). Keeping the screen on and the Shortcuts app in the foreground during a large manual run may still help, and does no harm, but don't count on it fixing every case.
- If a run gets interrupted (you leave home, or tap Stop), nothing is lost — anything already uploaded stays backed up permanently. The next run just starts sweeping from your newest photos again rather than exactly where it left off; the already-completed blocks re-check quickly (no file transfer) before it reaches new ground.
- If the Shortcut itself appears to freeze with no error and no visible cause (rare, but a known Shortcuts app quirk unrelated to this system), force-quit it from the app switcher and run it again — nothing gets corrupted by an interrupted run, see the point above.

## The phone freezes while the Shortcut runs

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- Go to **iPhone Settings** → **Display & Brightness** → **Auto-Lock** → **Never** (temporarily, while running a large backup).
- Runs with thousands of photos can take several minutes — that's normal, not a freeze.
- If it truly stops responding: a forced restart of the iPhone is safe, nothing is lost (the server-side run is just left unfinished, harmlessly).

## The Shortcut's final notification shows blank numbers (New/Already had/Conflicts)

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Known cosmetic issue — the step that closes out the run (`/run/finish`) sometimes doesn't complete, so the summary doesn't always carry the numbers. **This doesn't affect the actual backup**: files still upload and save correctly. To confirm something was really saved, check the destination folder directly (see next section).

## How to check files are really being saved

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No technical steps needed: open the destination folder you chose in Windows Explorer — you should see Year/Month subfolders with your photos and videos inside.

## Still not working

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Contact whoever helped you install the system, or check the project's GitHub repository to report the issue.